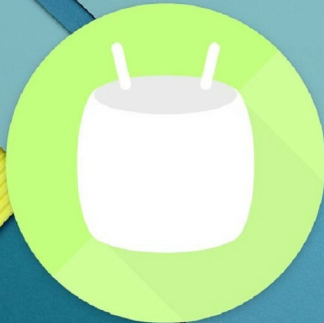


What's New in the Latest Android?



The ubiquitous Android handheld device has undergone a total metamorphosis since it first appeared in the market in 2007. The latest and hottest version of this mobile OS is the new Android 6.0, nicknamed Marshmallow. Get to know the salient features of Marshmallow in this introductory article.



Android is a mobile operating system developed by Google, which targets mobile phones and tablets. If you are familiar with or already use an Android device, you must be aware that Android leverages actions like taps and swipes to work with the device. If you are familiar with or already using an android device you must be aware that android leverage simple actions like tap, swipe to work with. Also this

is one the salient features of its UI utilising direct user manipulation.

Upon its arrival in the mobile phone market in 2007, it received a warm welcome and has now risen to be one of the most popular OSs in handheld devices these days.

Different versions of Android

Android has come a long way from its initial versions. Also, being available as open source software has increased the interest levels among developers on customising this OS for their own devices. Currently, there are many mobile phone vendors in the market using this OS.

Figure 1 gives a breakdown of the history of Android versions.

Android 6.0, code named Marshmallow, is the current latest available Android version (Figure 2).

New features in Android 6.0

The first thing you will notice is that the Android 6.0 UI is similar to Lollipop. However, there are many new features which are more contextually aware, like *Now on Tap*, which will assist users to get the information they require. Just holding on to the *Home* button will activate this feature, and using the words typed on the screen, Google will automatically fetch all relevant data (even if a third party app is involved). Here is how you can activate *Now On Tap*:

1. Open Settings
2. Under Personal - Open Google and Select "Search and Now"
3. You can use "Voice" or "Now Cards" to enable *Now on Tap* feature

In addition, Marshmallow will now support Type C USB devices, which can be fitted either way since these come with a reversible connector. These devices also provide better speed.

This Android version now features a brand new layout for the app drawer, which makes it quick and simple to check applications rather than scrolling sideways. Users now have to scroll down vertically, and this also comes with an option to search your favourite apps.

We have summarised the other features below.

- **More contextually aware Android**
 - This provides assistance for